



Two-Step Story Problem Task Cards

Grade 3 • Mathematics
Task Cards

Original Practice • Assessment • Complete Teacher Key



Teacher Guide

Level: Grade 3

State: North Carolina

Subject: Mathematics

Resource type: Task Cards

Estimated time: 35-45 minutes

Standard / objective: NC.3.OA.8 - Solve two-step word problems using addition, subtraction, and multiplication, representing problems with equations containing a symbol for the unknown.

Source note: North Carolina Department of Public Instruction, Mathematics Standards Vertical Progression:

<https://www.dpi.nc.gov/documents/publications/catalog/ma196-vertical-progression-math/open>; NC Check-Ins 2.0 Mathematics

Specifications: <https://www.dpi.nc.gov/documents/accountability/testing/nc-checkin/nc-check-ins-20-mathematics-grades-3-8-specifications> (accessed September 14, 2026).

What is included: branded cover, teacher guide, student directions, 16 original practice items, 5-item exit ticket, complete answer key/worked guidance, differentiation supports, printing notes, and license statement.

Purpose: Solve and represent two-step problems, then check whether answers are reasonable.

Preparation: Print student pages single-sided or assign through a secure LMS. Review the key and select tools allowed for your learners. No special commercial curriculum is required.

Access and differentiation

AIG: require a second representation, proof, counterexample, transfer task, or student-created extension. **504:** provide extended time, chunked sections, breaks, reduced copying, and accessible digital zoom as specified by the plan. **EC:** preteach vocabulary, model one item, provide manipulatives/visuals, and accept aligned response modes from the IEP. **ESL:** preview key terms, provide bilingual resources and sentence frames, and allow partner rehearsal. Use each learner's current plan; this guide does not replace it.



Student Practice

Learning focus: Solve and represent two-step problems, then check whether answers are reasonable.

Directions: Complete all items. Show calculations, cite evidence, or explain your reasoning when requested. Check your work before submitting.

1. A class packs 6 boxes with 8 markers each, then gives away 15 markers. How many remain?
2. Mia reads 24 pages Monday and 18 Tuesday. Her book has 70 pages. How many remain?
3. Four teams collect 9 cans each and then collect 17 more. Total?
4. A garden has 63 plants in 7 equal rows. Three plants in each row bloom. How many bloom?
5. A store had 85 notebooks, sold 29, then received 40. How many now?
6. Five buses carry 7 students each. Twelve more arrive by car. Total?
7. Write an equation for 9 bags of 4 apples with 11 apples eaten.
8. A player earns 8 points in each of 3 rounds and loses 5 penalty points. Score?



Student Practice - Continued

9. Lena has \$50, buys two games at \$14 each. Money left?
10. A baker makes 72 rolls, places 8 on each tray, and sells 4 trays. Rolls sold?
11. Choose the first operation: 6 shelves hold 5 books each; 9 are borrowed.
12. Explain how to check $7 \times 6 + 18 = 60$.
13. Create a two-step problem with answer 26.
14. A student says $4 \times 9 - 7 = 29$. Is the student correct?
15. Estimate whether $8 \times 6 + 13$ could equal 90.
16. Represent: 45 stickers shared among 5 students, then each gets 2 more.



Exit Ticket

Complete independently in 8-10 minutes.

1. State the main skill or concept in your own words.
2. Create one accurate example that uses today's skill.
3. Explain how you checked your example.
4. Identify one common error and correct it.
5. Rate your confidence from 1-4 and name your next practice step.

Quick rubric: 4 = accurate, complete, and well justified; 3 = accurate with minor omission; 2 = partial understanding; 1 = limited evidence; 0 = blank or unrelated.



Complete Teacher Answer Key

1. 33
2. 28
3. 53
4. 21
5. 96
6. 47
7. $9 \times 4 - 11 = 25$
8. 19
9. \$22
10. 32
11. Multiply 6×5
12. $42 + 18 = 60$; reverse with $60 - 18 = 42$
13. Answers vary; both operations and equation required.
14. Yes; $36 - 7 = 29$
15. No; $48 + 13 = 61$
16. $45 / 5 + 2 = 11$

Exit ticket guidance: Responses vary. Award full credit when the student accurately explains the focus, supplies a correct example, describes a valid check, identifies and corrects a realistic misconception, and chooses a specific next step.

Verification: Fixed responses and calculations were checked during production. Open responses are evaluated against the criteria above.

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